

Basic Starter Materials.

The exact ingredients, molds and tools to buy before your first batch — with quantities, approximate costs, and where to find them.

-  The complete starter shopping list
-  Molds compared — silicone vs polycarbonate
-  What to buy first vs what can wait
-  Total starter budget, low and comfortable versions
-  Where to buy each item

Contents

Print Section 5 and take it shopping — it's built to be your checklist.

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Introduction · Buy the minimum, not the maximum

"You need less than you think to make your first 3-4 batches. Buy the starter list, make your first capsules, and only then decide what's worth upgrading."

It's tempting to buy every flavor ingredient and every mold shape before your first attempt. Resist it. This bonus gives you a starter list that covers 8-10 flavors and produces professional-looking capsules — everything else in the training's 25 flavors can be added ingredient by ingredient as you go.

✓ **Total starter investment.** A complete starter kit — chocolate, 3-4 filling bases, one good mold, and the basic tools — runs **\$45-70** and produces 40-60 capsules across your first few batches. That's well under the cost of most hobby starter kits, and it's reusable for every future batch.

SECTION 1 OF 6

Chocolate & couverture

The single most important purchase — it's what your customer tastes and sees first.

TYPE	BEST FOR	STARTER QTY	APPROX. COST
Dark couverture (54-60% cacao)	Classic, Rich Chocolate, Mocha Fudge and coffee-forward flavors	1 kg	\$12-18
Milk couverture	Caramel, Dulce de Leche, Toffee, Hazelnut, most sweeter flavors	1 kg	\$12-18
White couverture	White Chocolate Bliss, Pistachio, Red Velvet coloring base	500 g	\$8-12

⚠ **Couverture, not "compound" or "candy melts."** Real couverture chocolate (with cocoa butter) tempers to a glossy, snappy shell that survives handling and looks professional. Compound coating is cheaper but melts and marks more easily, and customers notice the difference in taste.

SECTION 2 OF 6

Filling ingredients

Four base ingredients unlock 8-10 of the 25 flavors in the main training.

INGREDIENT	FLAVORS IT ENABLES	STARTER QTY	APPROX. COST
Instant coffee (fine granules)	Classic, Mocha Fudge, Tiramisu	100 g	\$4-6
Full-fat milk powder	Milk Powder, Classic, base for most fillings	500 g	\$6-9
Unsweetened cocoa powder	Rich Chocolate, Mocha Fudge, Red Velvet	250 g	\$4-6
Fine granulated & powdered sugar	All flavors — sweetness base	1 kg total	\$3-5

Add these three when ready to expand: **hazelnut praline paste** (Hazelnut), **freeze-dried strawberry powder** (Creamy Strawberry), and **dulce de leche** (Dulce de Leche, Butterscotch base) — roughly \$18-25 combined for enough to make several batches.

Molds — silicone vs polycarbonate

Your mold choice affects shine, ease of unmolding, and how professional the final capsule looks.

	SILICONE SPHERE MOLD	POLYCARBONATE SPHERE MOLD
Shine & finish	Good, slightly matte	Excellent, glossy — professional look
Ease of unmolding	Very easy, flexes to release	Requires proper tempering to release cleanly
Durability	2-3 years typical	5+ years, more scratch-resistant
Beginner-friendly	Yes — start here	Better once you're comfortable tempering
Typical cost (4-6 cm sphere, 6-8 cavities)	\$8-14	\$18-28

Our recommendation. Start with a silicone half-sphere mold (6-8 cm total capsule size once joined) for your first 3-4 batches. Move to polycarbonate once your tempering is consistent — the shinier finish noticeably increases perceived value in photos and in person.

SECTION 4 OF 6

Tools & equipment

Beyond the mold, a handful of kitchen tools you likely already own — plus two worth buying.

TOOL	HAVE IT ALREADY?	APPROX. COST IF BUYING
Heatproof glass or metal bowl	Usually yes	—
Small saucepan (for a bain-marie / double boiler)	Usually yes	—
Digital kitchen scale (grams)	Sometimes	\$10-15
Instant-read or chocolate thermometer	Rarely	\$8-15
Offset spatula / palette knife	Sometimes	\$5-8
Small piping bags or squeeze bottle	Sometimes	\$4-6
Fine-mesh sieve (for smooth fillings)	Usually yes	—

 **The one non-negotiable purchase.** A digital scale and a thermometer are worth buying even if you have to skip something else — chocolate tempering is precise, and "eyeballing" grams and temperature is the #1 cause of dull, bloom-prone shells for beginners.

Your starter shopping list

Print this page and take it with you — organized exactly as you'll shop.

Starter shopping list — Low budget version

☐ Dark couverture 1 kg	\$12-18
☐ Milk couverture 1 kg	\$12-18
☐ Instant coffee 100 g	\$4-6
☐ Milk powder 500 g	\$6-9
☐ Cocoa powder 250 g	\$4-6
☐ Sugar (granulated + powdered) 1 kg	\$3-5
☐ Silicone sphere mold, 6-8 cavities	\$8-14
Total (chocolate + fillings + mold)	\$49-76



Add-ons — Comfortable version

☐ White couverture 500 g	\$8-12
☐ Hazelnut praline paste 200 g	\$8-12
☐ Freeze-dried strawberry powder 50 g	\$6-9
☐ Dulce de leche 250 g	\$4-6
☐ Digital scale	\$10-15
☐ Chocolate thermometer	\$8-15
Total add-ons	\$44-69

Where to buy each item

Practical sourcing options so you're not stuck hunting for couverture chocolate.

- **Couverture chocolate:** baking supply stores, restaurant/bakery supply shops, or online chocolate specialty retailers — look for "couverture" on the label, not "chocolate flavored coating."
- **Molds:** baking supply stores or online kitchenware retailers — search "silicone half-sphere chocolate mold."
- **Filling ingredients** (coffee, milk powder, cocoa, sugar): any regular grocery store.
- **Specialty fillings** (praline paste, freeze-dried fruit powder): baking specialty stores or online — these are the two ingredients most worth ordering online if unavailable locally.
- **Scale & thermometer:** kitchenware stores or general online marketplaces — no need for a professional-grade version to start.

✓ **Congratulations.** You now have a complete, budgeted shopping list. Next: **Bonus 5 • Serving Instructions For Your Customers** — a printable insert card you can include in every kit.

Everything you need, nothing you don't.

You now have an exact, budgeted shopping list for your first batches — no guessing what to buy or how much.

Next step

Open **Bonus 5 • Serving Instructions For Your Customers** to prepare the printable insert for every kit you sell.

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